County of San Diego, Health and Human Services Agency (HHSA) CalWORKs/CalFresh/Medi-Cal/General Relief/Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants/County Medical Services Program Guide Special Notice

	Number	Page
Earned Income Tax Credit Outreach	**CW 24-01 CF 24-02 MC 24-01 GR 24-01 CAPI 24-01 CMS 24-01**	**1 of 6**

Effective Date:
February 1, 2024

Background:
San Diego County's Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) campaign continues to provide services annually. The outreach materials are provided to supplement EITC outreach efforts and are revised to reflect changes each tax year.

Purpose:
The purpose of this Special Notice is to provide revised federal EITC, California EITC (CalEITC) as well as other tax credit income limits, maximum credit amounts, and their impact on self-sufficiency programs. This material also provides resources to assist customers to access tax credits for which they are potentially eligible.

Policy:
Age and General EITC Eligibility
California tax filers may qualify for either federal and/or state EITC depending on their income, age, and number of children. Refer to Appendix B for income limits and credit amounts.

Federal EITC Eligibility:
- Must have earned income and adjusted gross income within certain limits but must be at least $1.
- Must meet certain basic rules. For example, have a valid Social Security Number (SSN).
- Must meet qualifying child rules if any dependent children are claimed.
- Must live in the United States for more than half the tax year.
- Claiming the federal EITC requires the Schedule EIC form available on the EITC webpage or by calling the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) at 800-829-1040.

CalEITC Eligibility:
- CalEITC is available to qualified tax filers ages 18 to 65 without qualifying children or any age with qualifying children.
- Must have an SSN or an Individual Tax Identification Number (ITIN) for undocumented individuals.
- Must have earned income and adjusted gross income of at least $1 and less than $30,950.
- Must meet qualifying child rules if any dependent children claimed.
- Must live in California for more than half the tax year.
- Claiming the CalEITC requires the FTB 3514 form available on the CalEITC website or by contacting the Franchise Tax Board by phone at 800-852-5711.

Note: California taxpayers may qualify for state credits even if they do not qualify for federal credits.

New Foster Youth Tax Credit (FYTC)

Eligible current and former foster youth who file their California state tax return and claim the FYTC will receive up to $1,117 in tax credits. The credit amount is adjusted for inflation annually and phases out gradually as income rises above $30,950. The FYTC is awarded per eligible individual. An individual may qualify for FYTC if they meet all the following criteria:

- Qualify for the CalEITC.
- Were age 18 through 25 at the end of the 2023 tax year.
- Were in foster care at age 13 or older and placed through the California foster care system.

Expanded Young Child Tax Credit (YCTC)

The YCTC has been expanded for the 2023 tax year. The YCTC increased to $1,083 per family. Families must have at least one child under six years old at the end of the tax year and must file a California state tax return and meet the requirements of the CalEITC. Beginning in the 2023 tax year, taxpayers do not need to have earned income to be eligible if they otherwise meet CalEITC requirements. If filing for prior years, customers must have at least $1 of earned income to qualify.

Procedure:

Free Tax Preparation Services

Free tax preparation services are available for low to moderate income individuals. Customers can call 2-1-1 for more information. Customers can also log on to:

- https://211sandiego.org/
- https://www.myfreetaxes.org/
  MyFreeTaxes.com is operated by United Way Worldwide and offers free state and federal tax preparation and filing services. For the 2023 tax year, tax filers will have the option to choose to file "By Myself," "With Assistance" or "I'm Not Sure". Based on their request, the information will be routed to the appropriate tax preparation model through a virtual assistant software, or in-person drop off. Services are free for households with earnings less than $60,000 for in person help or $66,000 or less if filing with virtual help.
- https://www.getyourrefund.org/en
  For the 2023 tax year, United Way has partnered with Code for America to provide virtual free tax credit services with IRS certified volunteers for household with earnings less than $66,000.
- https://www.eitc.irs.gov
- https://www.irs.gov/
- www.ftb.ca.gov/caleitc
- https://www.sco.ca.gov/eo_vita.html
  The IRS Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) Program offers free tax assistance to households with income of $60,000 or less. For the 2023 tax year, these services will be predominantly virtual or will require an appointment due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

EITC Postcards

The County of San Diego's Office of Equitable Communities- Community Action Partnership (CAP) and local nonprofit agency Dreams of Change will coordinate the distribution of EITC postcards and virtual EITC presentations to various Family Resource Centers (FRCs) and Employment Services (ES) sites as requested. Postcards (see Appendix A) will be distributed to ES, Refugee Employment Services (RES), Public Health Clinics, City and County libraries, schools, and Childcare contractors. Post cards are available in all threshold languages.

In addition, a flyer (Appendix B) containing postcard information with VITA site locations and phone numbers is being distributed via SMS message to CalWORKs, CalFresh and Medi-Cal customers and is available on the sandiegocounty.gov website.

These EITC publications:

- Strengthen state and county efforts to promote the EITC to our customer population.
- Target families and individuals who qualify for EITC.
- Educate and assist families on how to access EITC.

FRC, ES, RES and Child Care Staff Action

FRC and contracted staff will distribute these postcards to customers at all contacts and encourage them to contact 2-1-1 to receive free assistance to file their taxes and claim EITC and other tax credits available to them. If additional postcards are needed, FRC/ES Managers, or their designees, may contact the Office of Equitable Communities- Community Action Partnership (CAP) at (619) 338-2799.

Impacts:

CalWORKs and CalFresh

- Income
  Federal and state EITC payments, whether received as advanced payments or as a single payment, are exempt as income in determining CalWORKs and CalFresh eligibility or benefits level (CPG 44-100.C; CFPG 63-224, 63-224).
- Resource
  EITC payments and refund payments are exempt resources for 12 months, starting with the month that the payment is received (CPG 44-100.H2; CFPG 63-203, 63-204).

Medi-Cal

- Income
  EITC payments received as tax refunds or advanced payments are exempt from consideration as income (MPG 10.02.01 and Desk Aid 56 – MAGI Income and Deduction Types).
- Resource
  The Asset test for Medi-Cal was eliminated effective 1/1/2024.

General Relief (GR)

- Income
  General Relief considers EITC payments as unearned income in the month received (GRPG 90-400.5F). If a customer received General Relief during 2023, and the customer receives EITC, the case must be reviewed for potential unreported earned income since EITC is for earned income.
- Resource
  Any portion of the refund retained by the customer in the month following receipt is considered personal property (GRPG 90-400.5F).

Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants (CAPI)

- Income
  CAPI exempts EITC from consideration as income in the month received (CAPI PG 99-103.2B).
- Resource
  CAPI exempts EITC as a resource for 12 months following the month of receipt (CAPI PG 99-104.4B).

County Medical Services (CMS)

- Income
  CMS exempts EITC as income in the month received (CMSPG 06.01.02A).
- Resource
  Any portion of the refund retained by the beneficiary in the month following receipt is considered exempt personal property (CMSPG 06.04.03H).

Automation:
On the **Income List** section, enter the Income as **Miscellaneous Type: Tax/Refunds/Rebates/Credits**. CalSAWS will count this entry as countable income for the General Relief program and will exempt as income for the CalWORKs, CalFresh, Medi-Cal, CAPI, and Refugee Cash Assistance.

References:
All County Information Notice No. I-74-23
All County Information Notice No. I-74-23E

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by February 28,2025.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Service

Appendix A



FILE YOUR TAXES FOR *FREE!*

You may qualify for FREE tax filing assistance with an expert tax preparer.

Receive free tax filing assistance online or at a VITA (Volunteer Income Tax Assistance) site!

You may qualify for federal tax credits such as the Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) and Child Tax Credit (CTC) and state credits such as the California EITC (CalEITC) and Young Child Tax Credit (YCTC) that can put money back in your pocket. Our trusted tax preparers will see if you qualify for other available tax credits to maximize your refund or reduce the amount you owe. Let us help you get the money you deserve!

Who Is Eligible?

Individuals/families, including Individual Taxpayer Identification Number (ITIN) filers, earning:

- **$1– $64,000 per year** can get free tax assistance and may qualify to claim federal tax credits
- **$1– $30,950 per year** may qualify for additional state tax credits

What You'll Need

- Photo ID
- Social Security Card or ITIN for yourself and any dependent(s)
- Income documents including any W2s or 1099s
- Bank account information for direct deposit
- School tuition or student loan interest statements
- Dates of health coverage for yourself and any dependent(s)

How To File

- **Call 2-1-1** or go to **myfreetaxes.org** to see if you qualify and to make an appointment.
- Tax preparation services are available in multiple languages.
- Qualifying individuals can receive in-person tax assistance or file online for free by going to myfreetaxes.org.

Call 2-1-1 or visit myfreetaxes.org to learn more!

SAN DIEGO COUNTY EITC COALITION

This program is brought to you by the San Diego County EITC Coalition and the following partners:

IRS

CalEITC.me

¡PRESENTE SU DECLARACIÓN DE IMPUESTOS DE FORMA *GRATUITA!*

Es posible que reúna los requisitos para recibir asistencia GRATUITA para presentar su declaración de impuestos con un experto en preparar presentaciones de impuestos.

¡Reciba asistencia gratuita para la presentación de la declaración de impuestos en línea o en un sitio del programa de Asistencia Voluntaria para la Presentación del Impuesto sobre la Renta (Volunteer Income Tax Assistance, VITA)!

Puede calificar para créditos tributarios federales, como el Crédito del Impuesto sobre la Renta del Trabajo (Earned Income Tax Credit, EITC) y el Crédito Tributario por Hijos (Child Tax Credit, CTC), y créditos estatales, como el EITC de California (CalEITC) y el Crédito Tributario por Hijos Menores (Young Child Tax Credit, YCTC), que pueden devolverle dinero a su bolsillo. Nuestros preparadores de impuestos de confianza verán si usted califica para otros créditos tributarios disponibles para maximizar su reembolso o reducir el monto que adeuda. ¡Permítanos ayudarle a obtener el dinero que se merece!

¿Quién cumple con los requisitos?

Personas/familias, incluidos los declarantes con Número de Identificación Personal de Contribuyente (Individual Taxpayer Identification Number, ITIN), que ganan:

- **De $1 a $64,000 por año;** pueden obtener asistencia tributaria gratuita y pueden calificar para reclamar créditos tributarios federales
- **De $1 a $30,950 por año;** pueden calificar para créditos tributarios estatales adicionales

Lo que necesitará

- Identificación con fotografía
- Tarjeta de Seguro Social o ITIN para usted y cualquier dependiente
- Documentos de sus ganancias, incluidos los formularios W2 o 1099
- Información de la cuenta bancaria para depósito directo
- Estados contables de la matrícula escolar o de intereses de préstamos estudiantiles
- Fechas de cobertura médica para usted y cualquier dependiente

Cómo presentar una solicitud

- **Llame al 2-1-1** o visite **myfreetaxes.org** para comprobar si reúne los requisitos y programar una cita.
- Los servicios de preparación de impuestos están disponibles en varios idiomas.
- Las personas que reúnan los requisitos pueden recibir asistencia tributaria en persona o presentar su solicitud en línea de forma gratuita en myfreetaxes.org.

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Appendix B

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Tax Year 2023 CalEITC Income Limits

Number of Qualifying Children	State EITC Income Limits	State EITC Maximum Credits
None	$30,950	$285
1	$30,950	$1,900
2	$30,950	$3,137
3 or more	$30,950	$3,529

Tax Year 2023 Federal EITC Income Limits

Number of Qualifying Children	Single, Head of Household or Widowed	Married Filing Jointly	Federal EITC Maximum Credits (Up To)
None	$17,640	$24,210	$600
1	$45,560	$53,120	$3,995
2	$52,918	$59,478	$6,604
3 or more	$56,838	$63,398	$7,430

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Limites de Ingresos– 2023 CalEITC:

Numeron de Ninos que califican	Limites de ingresos para el EITC estatal	Creditos maximos para el EITC estatal
0	$30,950	$285
1	$30,950	$1,900
2	$30,950	$3,137
3 o mas	$30,950	$3,529

Limites de Ingresos federales del EITC:

Numeron de Ninos que califican	Soltero, jefe de familia o viudo	Casado y declara en conjunto	Creditos maximos para el EITC federal
0	$16,480	$22,610	$560
1	$43,492	$49,622	$3,733
2	$49,399	$55,529	$6,164
>3	$53,057	$59,187	$6,935

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